day interactions in the family'.[91] This was the second major resolution passed by the ABPS on education in the mother tongue.

Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat underscored this priority when he told swayamsevaks that while 'we should respect all the languages and consider them at par with our mother-tongue,' they should 'interact in our [own] languages'. He was appealing, he said, not only to the government but also to the media that 'language should be used in its pristine form'.[92]

Textbooks, Changes and the SBAS

The Sangh Parivar's concerns on education narratives are exemplified by the single-minded focus of the controversial Shikhsha Bachao Andolan Samiti (SBAS), spearheaded by the RSS's Dinanath Batra and set up in 2004. With the BJP having recently lost power and with a new HRD minister and many leftist historians and educationists calling for 'detoxification' of education, several Sangh Parivar individuals came together on 2 July 2004 in Delhi to form the SBAS.[93] Among the first causes it took up, in 2007, was the reversal of what it saw as the introduction of 'graphic sex education' in secondary school textbooks from Class Six onwards by the UPA. The introduction of sex education in school was seen as a triumph of scientific knowledge by many educationists. In the RSS's view, it was a perversion: 'Whether by design or sheer negligence, textbook content started yielding negativity, untruths, distortion of facts and at times even perversity.' In the eyes of the SBAS, sex education was a move 'by certain forces in the education sector to sabotage young minds'.[94]

In 2008, after forcing NCERT to initially withdraw what is perceived as objectionable passages, pressure from SBAS caused the UPA government to backtrack and significantly modify sex education modules taught in schools.[95]

The list of causes that the Samiti took up says all there is to say about its outlook on education. It filed eleven cases in court and won all of them: the removal of A.K. Ramanujan's celebrated essay, 'Three Hundred Ramayanas: Five Examples and Three Thoughts on